

Venice

Venice's architecture developed as a fusion of Italian, Byzantine and Islamic ideas. Sculptor and architect Jacopo d'Antonio Sansovino (1486–1570) introduced High Renaissance architecture there, particularly in his Biblioteca Marciana (1537–60) and mint (1537–45), facing the Doge's Palace (opposite). Palladio declared that the library, with its 21-bay arcade and barrel-vaulted staircase, was the finest building erected since antiquity. Scamozzi extended Sansovino's library and completed Palladio's San Giorgio Maggiore and Teatrino Olimpico after their deaths. His treatise *The Idea of a Universal Architecture*, along with buildings such as the Palazzo Contarini (1609–16), provide a link between the High Renaissance and the baroque. Baldassare Longhena (1598–1682), who trained with Scamozzi, completed his Procuratie Nuove in St Mark's Square. His Santa Maria della Salute shows the influence of Palladian classicism, while its huge dome is anchored by massive baroque scrolls to an octagonal base, and his Ca' Pesaro (begun 1659) exemplifies the Venetian baroque.

